Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Council - October 27th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wwWOlzA8TX0
Publication Date	2026-10-28T02:14:01Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 27, 2026
Governing Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting of the Delaware County Council to order on October 27, 2026, at 00:08:32.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Mr. Brookout, Mr. Flanigan, Mr. Mogul, Miss Piper, Mr. Whead (spelled Wad/Wahhead in various roll calls), Mr. Can, Mr. Hughes, and Mr. Freeman (exact roll call at 00:09:01 listed Mr. Brookout, Mr. Flanigan, Mr. Mogul, Miss Piper, Mr. Whead, Mr. Can, Mr. Hughes, and Mr. Freeman).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly titled by name in the opening statement, but managing proceedings as council president/chair.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Brad (00:08:40).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
  - September 22, 2026, council meeting minutes approved by roll call vote following a motion by Eugene and second by Jessica (00:09:48).
  - October 7, 2026, budget adoption meeting minutes approved with one small correction regarding a resolution roll call vote, following a motion by Eugene and second by Jessica (00:10:15).
- **Agenda Amendments:** The agenda was approved as amended to add the receipt of the Sheriff<U+2019>s Commissary Report under New Business (00:09:19).

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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Transfers & Appropriations <U+2014> County General & Courts

- 00:11:02 **County General Courts Transfer (Fund 138 - Courts):**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court representative.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of $155,000 across line items ($5,000 to operating supplies, $50,000 to professional services for psychological evaluations, and $100,000 to other services and charges for jury fees) funded by an overage in health insurance. The court noted anticipated upcoming murder trials and the need for supplies for incoming judges. Total transfer: $0 net change.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:14:10) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:14:27 **Public Defender Transfer (Fund 139):**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley (Public Defender).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of $21,000 from county employee salary line into attorney fee lines to cover attorney stipends/fees for complex trials. Total transfer: $0 net change.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:18:15) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:18:30 **Communications Transfer & Tower Discussion:**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications / 911).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine annual transfer adjusting overtime and holiday pay, plus a $60,000 transfer into equipment for radio equipment needed after a recent flooding event. Total transfer: $0 net change. Fred also updated the council on a $291,000 VHF system project (including a monopole and repeaters) required due to flooding vulnerabilities, noting plans to seek $50,000 via additional appropriation

next month while sourcing the rest internally. A broader discussion occurred regarding the $1.7 million Sams Street Tower replacement cost, potential FEMA reimbursement, insurance coverage denials from Chubb/USI regarding statement-of-values technicalities, and state bond bank emergency loan options (2% interest over two years for the first $1 million).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Transfer approved by roll call vote (00:20:16) following a motion by Jeff and second by Dan. (Tower/VHF matters required no formal vote; informal consensus given to explore options).
- 00:39:45 **Board of Health Transfer (Fund 1159):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bane, Health Department Administrator.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of $500 to education incentive pay matched by $500 from health insurance. Total transfer: $0 net change.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:40:18) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:41:01 **Cumulative Bridge Transfer (Fund 1135 / 190):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kerry (County Highway).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of $100,000 from bridge repairs/maintenance to infrastructure for design work on Bridge 502 (Garfield Street bridge over Buck Creek). Total project cost is $5.18 million, with a 20% local match ($1.036 million). Total transfer: $0 net change.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:43:44) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:44:33 **Galcasa Wellness Project Transfer (Fund 9115):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant program representative.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of $650 within VOCA grant funding lines to cover previously approved pay increases for two positions. Because it was filed late, it required unanimous approval. Total transfer: $0 net change.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:46:22) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:46:54 **Sheriff's Department Appropriations (County General Fund 129):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of $3,275 in overtime from a grant (used for fairgrounds security) and $10,000 in other supplies from court-awarded forfeiture funds misrouted into county general. Total appropriation: $13,275.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:48:50) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan.
- 00:49:12 **Ambulance Replacement & Pension Supplement Appropriations (Fund 4907 / 4915):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County official.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of $100,000 from the pension supplement fund to other capital outlays for two new pickup trucks to run as squad

trucks/reserves, and a corresponding major transfer/appropriation of $100,000 from pension supplement to ambulance replacement for vehicle upgrades. Pension supplement remains fully funded.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both items approved by roll call vote (00:50:54 and 00:51:48) following motions by Jessica and seconds by Dan.
- 00:52:05 **Galcasa Equipment Appropriation (Fund 1212):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant representative / Jamie.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of $17,500 from a Delaware County Community Foundation fund to equipment lines to replace nine aging computer desktops with docking stations/laptops.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:54:12) following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan. Financial transfers and salary ordinance amendments with like reductions approved en bloc via roll call at 00:54:35. Backfilling report received via roll call at 00:55:09.

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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period (00:11:45 / 01:11:45).*

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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
    - **Appointments:** The council reviewed upcoming board appointment expirations as of December 31. Expressions of interest are due to Marissa by November 25, 2026 (00:55:36).
    - **Meeting Schedule:** The proposed 2027 council meeting schedule (meeting on the fourth Tuesday monthly with specific exceptions for spring break, Thanksgiving, and December) was approved following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan (00:10:00 / 01:00:28).
    - **Treasurer Report:** Brad Polk (Delaware County Treasurer) reported on the October 14 tax sale: 1,217 properties certified, 573 paid prior to sale ($1.353 million collected), 183 properties sold at auction, and surplus collections totaling $3.222 million. Total outstanding uncollected tax for 2026 stands around $9 million across taxing units. Interest earnings through three quarters total $2,223,710.84, projected to reach $2.96<U+2013>3.07 million by year-end (01:02:05).
    - **Commissioner Update:** Steven Brand noted online board application portals and corrected the Bridge 502 construction timeline (letting in July 2031, construction in FY 2032) (01:08:08).

    - **MUSK Committee Update:** Report successfully finalized and submitted to the state on the morning of the meeting, reflecting positive feedback from participating towns regarding tax rates and budget gaps (01:10:02).
    - **Election Reminder:** Council reminded citizens that early voting is underway and election day is one week away (01:12:02).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion by Jessica, a second by Dan, and a roll call vote (01:12:23). The next regular meeting is scheduled for November 17, 2026 (01:12:40).

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